16.3 Neonatal Jaundice and Phototherapy

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • Mother says • "The baby looks yellow." **Objective** • Yellow down to the chest on day 3 • Serum bilirubin above the treatment line • Sleepy at feeds	**ACTUAL** **Neonatal hyperbilirubinemia** related to immature liver function and delayed feeding as evidenced by jaundice and raised bilirubin.	Bilirubin falls below the treatment threshold.	• Start phototherapy as ordered, with the eyes covered. • Expose as much skin as possible and change position as policy says. • Feed often, at least every 3 hours. • Check bilirubin as ordered.	Bilirubin falling: **goal met**.
Subjective • Mother asks • "Can I hold my baby?" **Objective** • Baby under phototherapy • Mother tearful	**ACTUAL** **Anxiety (parent)** related to infant treatment and separation as evidenced by questions and worry.	Mother understands the treatment and joins in with care.	• Explain what phototherapy is for and roughly how long it will take. • Let her hold the baby for feeds as policy allows. • Encourage her to keep breastfeeding.	Mother joining in: **goal met**.
Subjective • *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Under phototherapy	**RISK** **Risk for deficient fluid volume** as evidenced by risk factors: increased insensible losses under phototherapy.	Baby stays well hydrated.	• Count wet diapers. • Weigh every day. • Watch the temperature. • Feed at least every 3 hours.	Hydrated: **goal met**.